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Hiring Team, Navan

Your posting asks for someone who can be "a critical enabler of deal formation and execution," minimizing sales cycle time while still protecting revenue and margin. At Sensata I ran a version of that discipline directly: leading the Bleeders and Leakers program, negotiating deal by deal against competitive gaps and each customer's own willingness to pay, and recovering \$700K plus in margin in two quarters. That required moving fast without loosening the deal review.

The part of the role that is harder to find is the quoting and pricing-model fluency underneath it. I set up and run PriceKeel's own CRM, CPQ configuration and deal-approval workflow myself, including the guardrail that catches a non-standard deal request before it reaches final review and the audit trail that gives Finance an explainable, revenue-recognition-ready record behind every exception. That is the same enforcement of standard business practices your deal reviews and early checkpoints are built around, just built from the system side instead of the sales-support side.

Cross-functional ownership is not new to me either. At Sensata I partnered with senior executives and Finance on AP26 revenue models and multimillion-dollar customer quotes, then built the FY2026 Bleeders and Leakers Power BI dashboard tracking 1,200 pricing opportunities against a \$627M target across three regions, surfacing \$433M in margin gaps by salesperson so leadership could prioritize instead of guess. Raising distributor and channel-partner margins from 53% to 61% in that same program came from restructuring sophisticated multi-party terms and documenting the new discount logic clearly enough for Finance, legal and sales operations to all work from the same page.

Right now, as Strategic Marketing III at Applied Materials, I automate repetitive pricing and forecasting analysis with Claude AI agents, the kind of process-enforcement habit a growing Deal Desk function needs to scale across geographies. I would bring someone who has already made the pricing call and built the system that enforces it, not someone learning CPQ configuration on the job. Proof trail: adhi-pricing-ai.vercel.app/ref/navan

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